



COMMUNICATION IN ENGLISH II



# LANGUAGE SKILLS

CHINYERE OMENI-NZEWUIHE  
MA. ENGLISH STUDIES



### LEARNING OBJECTIVES

---

At the end of the lesson, you should be able to:

- Grasp the fundamental concepts and distinctions between listening, speaking, reading and writing as essential language skills.
- Increase your proficiency in each language skill.
- Synthesise and apply your language skills in real-world scenarios.
- Analyse and evaluate information through reading and listening.





### INTRODUCTION

---

Why do you think some of the most powerful leaders, writers, and speakers in history have been exceptionally skilled in using language?

What role does language skills play in shaping our world?





### KEY LANGUAGE SKILLS

---

#### Building Blocks of Effective Communication

- Listening
- Speaking
- Reading
- Writing





# LISTENING SKILLS



### LISTENING SKILLS

---

What's the difference between listening and hearing?





# LISTENING SKILLS

---

### The Art of Active Listening

Listening: The ability to understand, interpret, and respond to spoken language.

Listening to a TED Talk and summarizing the main ideas.

Listening can be in any number of forms and purpose. For examples: listening tasks, audio books or textbooks, instructions, descriptions, etc.



# LISTENING SKILLS - ACTIVE VS. PASSIVE LISTENING

---

### Active vs. Passive Listening

Active listening involves full engagement, while passive listening is merely hearing without deep comprehension.

Example: Active listening during a lecture vs. passive listening to background music.







# SPEAKING SKILLS



### SPEAKING SKILLS

---

#### Expressing Thoughts and Ideas

The ability to articulate thoughts, ideas, and information coherently and effectively.

Let's give example with a persuasive speech on a controversial topic.

Topic: *The Legalisation of Assisted Suicide: A Case for Personal Autonomy*





### SPEAKING SKILLS

---

Topic: *The Legalisation of Assisted Suicide: A Case for Personal Autonomy*

Introduction - *'I believe that the legalisation of assisted suicide is a matter of personal autonomy and should be allowed under certain circumstances.'*

Body: In the body, you will eloquently talk about the historical context of the topic, present arguments to favour legalising suicide, such as personal autonomy, compassion, and reducing suffering. Also consider to include ethical considerations including the sanctity of life and potential for abuse, this way you have covered both sides of the argument.



### SPEAKING SKILLS

---

#### Oral Communication

Effective speaking includes clear pronunciation, appropriate tone, the ability to engage the audience, voice control, your body language and delivery.

Example: Answering relevant questions during a job interview.





### SPEAKING SKILLS

---

Interviewer: Tell me about yourself.

Job Seeker A: Certainly, I have a background in marketing and have spent the last five years working at TechyAmb, where I was responsible for managing social media campaigns and increasing engagement with our audience. I'm known for my creative problem-solving skills and my ability to work well in a team. In my free time, I enjoy painting and volunteering at a local animal shelter.





### SPEAKING SKILLS

---

Interviewer: Tell me about yourself.

Job Seeker B: Well, I like hanging out with friends, and I love watching TV shows. I'm not sure what to say about my work because, you know, it's just a job. Oh, and I have a cat named Whiskers.





# READING SKILLS





### READING SKILLS

---

The ability to comprehend, interpret, and analyse written text.

Example: Reading a complex research paper and extracting key findings.







# READING SKILLS - COMPREHENSION

---

## Reading Comprehension

Effective reading involves understanding main ideas, context, and subtext.

Example: Analysing a novel's symbolism and its impact on the story.





### READING SKILLS - COMPREHENSION

---

#### The Dangers of Faking Mental Health Issues

Faking mental health issues, whether for personal gain or attention, not only undermines the struggles of those genuinely afflicted but also poses significant dangers to individuals and society at large. When individuals feign mental health problems, they perpetuate stigmas surrounding mental health and diminish the credibility of real cases, making it more challenging for those who genuinely need support to be taken seriously. Furthermore, faking mental health issues can lead to unnecessary medical treatments, misallocation of resources, and a diversion of professional attention away from individuals who truly require assistance.





### READING SKILLS - COMPREHENSION

---

In essence, pretending to have mental health concerns is a disservice to the mental health community, ultimately hindering efforts to provide the help and resources necessary for those who are authentically suffering. Thus, promoting honesty and understanding surrounding mental health is imperative to ensure that those in need receive the support they require.





### READING SKILLS - COMPREHENSION

---

#### The Dangers of Faking Mental Health Issues

- Key takeaways

**Undermining Legitimacy:** Faking mental health problems diminishes the legitimacy of genuine cases, perpetuating stigmas and skepticism surrounding mental health.

**Obstructing Access to Support:** Feigning mental health issues can obstruct individuals who truly need help from receiving the support and resources they require.





### READING SKILLS - COMPREHENSION

---

**Misallocation of Resources:** Pretending to have mental health concerns can lead to misallocation of medical treatments and divert professional attention away from those in genuine need.

**Honesty and Understanding:** Promoting honesty and fostering understanding around mental health is crucial to ensure that authentic sufferers receive the necessary assistance and care.





# WRITING SKILLS



### WRITING SKILLS

---

Writing Skills

Crafting Words into Meaningful Messages

The capacity to convey thoughts, information, and emotions through written language.

Example: Composing a well-structured persuasive essay.







### WRITING SKILLS

---

#### Writing Styles

Explanation: Different forms of writing include persuasive, descriptive, narrative, and expository.





### WRITING SKILLS

---

#### The Benefits of Regular Exercise

Regular exercise is a cornerstone of a healthy and fulfilling life. It not only enhances physical fitness but also carries profound benefits for mental and emotional well-being. Engaging in regular physical activity reduces stress, anxiety, and depression, while simultaneously boosting self-esteem and confidence. Moreover, exercise is a powerful tool in preventing chronic health conditions like heart disease, diabetes, and obesity.

One of the immediate perks of exercise is the surge in energy levels. Whether you're running, cycling, or even taking a brisk walk, physical activity increases your stamina and leaves you feeling invigorated. With consistent exercise, you'll notice improved endurance, making everyday tasks feel easier.



### WRITING SKILLS

---

Sleep quality can significantly benefit from regular exercise. A tired body finds it easier to fall asleep and stay asleep, resulting in more restful nights. As sleep improves, so does cognitive function, mood, and overall productivity.

Incorporating exercise into your daily routine doesn't require drastic changes. Even simple activities like dancing, gardening, or playing a sport can contribute to a healthier lifestyle. The key is consistency. Small, regular efforts can lead to significant long-term health benefits.

In conclusion, regular exercise is a small investment that yields tremendous rewards. It enhances physical health, alleviates stress, boosts mental well-being, and contributes to better sleep. To experience the transformative power of exercise, prioritize it in your daily life. Your body and mind will thank you.



### LANGUAGE SKILLS

---

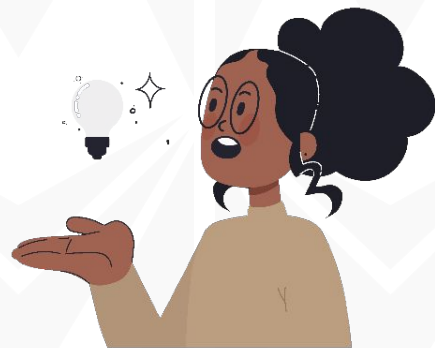
It is essential to note that when you combine these language skills effectively, you enhance your critical thinking, ability to engage complex discourse, and even gain a global perspective on issues.



### SUMMARY

---

So, as we wrap up this lesson on language skills, let's take a moment to reflect on what we've learned. We've seen that these skills are like puzzle pieces that fit together to create effective communication. It's not just about speaking or writing – it's also about listening and reading, and they all influence each other. Keep in mind that these skills are a lifelong journey. They keep evolving as we grow, and they're not just tools; they're like life companions.





### SUMMARY

---

What's Interesting is that they also boost our critical thinking abilities, helping us sift through a world full of information. It's not just about school or work; it's about personal growth too. Good communication is a superpower that transcends fields and can shape your career and personal life. Lastly, these skills open doors to understanding people from different backgrounds. They make us more empathetic and expand our horizons.

So, remember, as you continue on your educational journey, think about how these language skills are your allies in personal and intellectual growth, guiding your path and influencing your contributions to the world.



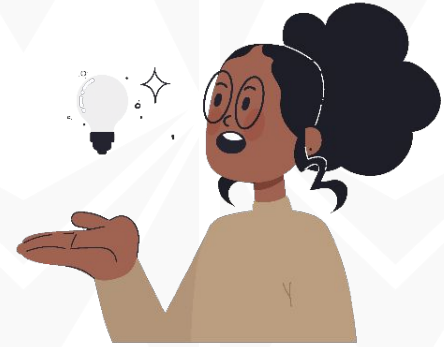
### REFERENCE & FURTHER READING

---

Pinker, S. (1995). The Language Instinct: How the Mind Creates Language.

Kermode, R. (2015). Speak So Your Audience Will Listen: 7 steps to Confident and Authentic Public Speaking.

Dehaene, S. (2009). Reading in the Brain: The Science and Evolution of a Human Invention.





THANK  
YOU